



MONTHLY UPDATE

AI: monthly update, July 2026

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38 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

On 25 July the Higher Education Minister announced that from the 2026–2027 academic year each student's learning pathway will be steered by an intelligent assistant matching modules to competences and career goals, alongside a large language model for lecturers that generates teaching material and [marks student answers](#). No appeal route, accuracy claim, disclosure duty or human-review threshold is reported. The figures given alongside are the minister's own, delivered in a speech, and none is independently sourced.

The strategy itself moved in August rather than July. A [joint inter-ministerial roadmap was agreed to deploy artificial intelligence across public services, prioritising sovereign open-source models, high-performance computing centres, national data storage and stronger safeguards for public-sector applications](#), reported on 12 August by the higher education minister, with intensive university training programmes, a dedicated research centre and specialised research units, and a joint monitoring committee established to oversee delivery against a stated timeline. The strategy text is still not published and the ethical-AI law has not moved.

Three external events are dated in the month and moved nothing. The Post and Telecommunications Minister told the inaugural [UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance](#) in Geneva on 6 July that global governance should move from principles to technology transfer and capacity building. Smart Africa's chief executive met him on [13 July](#) on AI adoption and digital integration; no agreement or commitment is reported. Algérie Télécom received a [WSIS Forum certificate of appreciation](#) on 9 July. The award is a certificate of appreciation; the ministry described it as confirmation of Algeria's standing.

Angola

At a trade fair on 22 July the second operator launched the web version of a subscription artificial-intelligence assistant at Kz 300 a month, replacing a text-message version, pitched at student research; no usage figure or model provenance is published.

The country's permanent representative to the United Nations argued on 31 July that persistent digital disparity keeps developing states out of artificial-intelligence rule-setting, and backed three international governance processes. That is a stated position rather than an instrument.

Burkina Faso

At a regional digital salon on 14 to 16 July, the monetary union's commission announced it would prepare a community artificial-intelligence strategy, counting this country among four member states already holding a national one — a count another source published five days earlier contradicts. An operator pitched credit scoring built on mobile-money patterns at the same event; no model-disclosure duty or contestation route for an automated refusal is on file. Six francophone West African states adopted common governance guidelines announced on 6 July, non-binding and complementary to national strategies.

Asked in plenary where AI sat in the new data-protection law, the justice minister said it was already integrated via the ban on transferring sensitive data abroad, with the national roadmap to become dedicated regulation later.

Burundi

Burundi's first documented AI-governance discussion took place in the professional community, not government. A [two-day workshop in Bujumbura on 27 July 2026, organised by the association of Burundian alumni of the German Academic Exchange Service](#), drew doctors, IT specialists, students and developers. The load-bearing statement came from the director-general of the Muganga Innovation Lab: Burundi has recently legislated on personal-data protection but holds a great deal of information and relatively little of it as structured, consented, usable data — the constraint that makes fairness and traceability arguments premature, and one no AI strategy addresses. Sessions covered AI ethics and labour displacement, AI for resource governance, UNESCO and ISO frameworks, and data governance for connected devices.

Cameroon

Cabinet was told on 30 July that the [national AI strategy is still being developed, with ten priority areas and a costed roadmap tabled](#) and no adoption instrument published; a 2040 roadmap on seven pillars had been presented in July 2025. The [AI authority and presidential council that roadmap provided for remain uncreated](#) and are absent from the ten priorities, which carry only adaptation of the legal framework. Among the priorities is a [national high-performance computing centre](#), announced with no site, cost, operator or timetable. At the same session the telecommunications minister said Cameroon had [acceded as a founding member of a global AI cooperation body](#); the accession date is not published.

Cape Verde

The Health Minister proposed at a World Health Organization conference in Lisbon on 15 July that Cape Verde serve as a lusophone laboratory for artificial intelligence in health, hosting pilot projects integrating it with telemedicine, and called for cooperation on skills, infrastructure, interoperability and an ethical and regulatory framework. No pilot, partner, budget or instrument follows from it.

Comoros

A Comorian graduate student, Soilahoudine Mohamed of Mvouni, [launched Komori Tts on 28 July 2026](#), described [as the first text-to-speech model for Shikomori](#), in an account published by Al-Watwan on 4 August. Mohamed, a graduate of Université Abdelmalek Essaâdi in Tétouan now reading for a master's in artificial intelligence and data science at Université Mohammed Premier in Oujda, states that no speech-synthesis model existed for Shikomori before this, against hundreds of languages elsewhere. He names two constraints: the cost of the computing resources needed to train the model, and the volume of paired text-and-audio data available. Extension to the three other island languages — shindzuani, shimwali and shimaore — is stalled for the same reason, with few translations and too few translators and validators received so far; the site's translation component remains experimental. The project is privately and individually funded, not a state or institutional programme.

Cote d'Ivoire

Six francophone West African states adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines announced on 6 July, non-binding and complementary to national strategies, submitted as a written contribution to a United Nations dialogue. The minister addressed that dialogue in Geneva on 6 and 7 July and proposed a regional African school of artificial intelligence.

Djibouti

On 17 July an upgraded AI weather early-warning system was [handed over at the World AI Conference in Shanghai](#). Version 2.0 adds observation and autonomous alerting through smart terminals combining satellite, ground data and forecast models, and sharpens forecast resolution to 3 km from 9 km. The first system was supplied by the China Meteorological Administration in July 2025 and entered service in December 2025.

The LinkWise interview of 23 July also [named a cross-border data corridor linking Shanghai to Djibouti among the arrangement's success indicators, alongside full Djiboutian jurisdiction over data natively generated on the territory](#), with chips specified as NVIDIA H and B series. The memorandum text is not held; the terms are the minister's account.

DR Congo

A stakeholder workshop of 23 to 27 July in Kinshasa [validated the draft national artificial intelligence strategy subject to amendments](#), on four pillars aligned to the national development plan on a 2030 horizon. No adoption date was established and the text is not held. The same sessions recorded that bodies already acting across digital, research, data, cybersecurity and regulation have [roles not yet sufficiently articulated in a common steering architecture](#).

Egypt

The [second edition of the national artificial-intelligence strategy is unchanged as an instrument](#), with delivery bodies added around it — a responsible-AI centre established late 2025 and a university capacity programme. The ICT minister describes [Karnak, a locally contextual Arabic large language model, as available to startups as a base for applications](#); no release date, licence, parameter count, access terms or user count is held, and the strategy text itself is not held either.

Equatorial Guinea

On 7 August 2026 Óscar Ondo Ngomo left the director-generalship of GITGE, which he had held for thirteen years, to become [Secretary of State charged with artificial intelligence](#) at the Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Civil Aviation; the account describes the portfolio as newly named at that level.

Eswatini

Eswatini's second instrument to carry AI rules arrived in the month, and like the first it is not an AI instrument: the [Online Media Publishing Guidelines 2026 bind registered publishers to the responsible use of AI](#), enforced through the registration requirement they create. There is still no national AI strategy or statute behind either.

On 6 July the prime minister told the [Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva that small and developing nations should not become mere consumers of technologies developed elsewhere](#), an address the National 4IR Strategy frames.

[A regional health body and a private firm signed a memorandum in Eswatini on 4 August to scale AI-enabled health solutions](#), naming no system, no data-sharing terms and no money.

Ethiopia

AI service bundles from an Ethiopian firm went on sale inside the same app on 22 July, bought with mobile money and redeemed by SMS voucher.

The state's artificial-intelligence capability claim rests on [the institute that built the unified service platform](#), established in 2020. Nothing held sets out its budget, headcount or research output.

Ghana

UNESCO's Accra head replied from the same platform that strategies without funding and execution remain shell documents.

Applications opened on 1 July for an applied artificial-intelligence lab in Accra, closing 31 August with no cohort size or Ghana-specific spend disclosed.

Guinea

Guinea joined five other Francophone West African states in [adopting shared AI governance guidelines, announced on 6 July 2026 and submitted to the United Nations' first Global AI Dialogue as a written contribution](#). The advocacy organisation Niyel led the work; the framework recommends transparent systems, stronger data protection, skills development and support for local innovation, and complements rather than replaces national strategies. The same account names Senegal and Côte d'Ivoire as the participants that have adopted national AI strategies and places the rest, Guinea included, as still developing their frameworks.

On 20 July, the digital economy minister and a Rwandan delegation [identified artificial intelligence, e-health, e-commerce and electronic invoicing as areas for cooperation](#). The article reports areas identified for exploration, not agreements signed.

Kenya

The draft AI policy was published for comment on 21 July and comment closed on 4 August. It runs to 226 pages, asserts [effects-based jurisdiction over entities outside Kenya](#) whose outputs have direct and foreseeable effects in the country, leaves "high risk" undefined and states no penalties. Its labour chapter [sets minimum standards for content moderators, data annotators and evaluators](#), binding on international firms operating through outsourcing partners.

An analysis published on 23 July recorded that the National AI Strategy, costed at KSh 152bn over five years, [carries no dedicated allocation in the 2026/27 budget](#). On 28 July the government and the UN development programme agreed progress on a national AI computing platform; no GPU count, cost or commissioning date was published. Kenya was named on 31 July as one of five governments launching a pooled African-language AI initiative.

The draft then drew its first substantive submission, and a headline figure. A civil-society organisation [urged institutional independence for the proposed AI council and mandatory human-rights impact assessments](#) on 14 August, with the draft reported as nearing Cabinet consideration. Alongside it, a commercial data compiler's mid-year update [put 97.5% of Kenya's online adults using an artificial-intelligence tool monthly, first globally, ahead of the United Arab Emirates at 94.2% and Indonesia at 93.6%](#). It is a self-reported survey of online adults rather than a population measure.

Lesotho

The same Econet-UNDP memorandum establishes a National AI Academy, with nothing naming a timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution for it. Econet Group separately states an agreement with NVIDIA for African AI compute capacity; nothing on file corroborates it and no capacity figure or siting is given.

At the UN Global Dialogue on AI Governance in Geneva, MICSTI Principal Secretary Kanono Ramashamole [argued that developing nations must be co-creators rather than only consumers of AI](#), naming fragmented data and weak governance as obstacles.

A [CIPIT paper published on 1 July](#) reads Lesotho's AI strategy against the African Union Continental AI Strategy and other national strategies, and finds intellectual property acknowledged as an enabler while training-data licensing, authorship of AI-generated works and infringement are engaged only to a limited extent.

Liberia

At the President's third national youth town hall in Buchanan on 29 July, the President's Youth Advisory Council called for artificial intelligence to be made a national priority through education frameworks, innovation and fabrication laboratories and skills provision. The President [did not dismiss it and conditioned support on applications in agriculture, transport and commerce; no policy, institution, budget line or date followed](#).

The country's first working legal AI was launched on 31 July: [CJ Lewis, built by the law library Liblaw over Supreme Court opinions from 1861 to 2026 plus statutes and regulations, with OHCHR support on human-rights principles in the design](#). No accuracy or evaluation figure is given, no model or vendor is named, and the corpus is a private compilation.

Madagascar

AXIAN Telecom was [named a founding partner of an African-language artificial-intelligence initiative on 28 July 2026](#). No Malagasy-language model or dataset has been released.

A [Madagascar-Egypt government partnership on the use of artificial intelligence in public administration and the sector's digital transition was reported on 1 August](#), with no date of signature given.

Malawi

A UNESCO artificial intelligence readiness assessment was validated in Lilongwe on 22 July 2026, run by the education ministry rather than by the ICT ministry that owns the draft national strategy. It reported gaps in policy, infrastructure, institutional capacity and education readiness, and put 27.7% of the population online with household computer ownership at 4.2% ([validation account](#)).

On 24 July the Defence Minister stated that the Malawi Defence Force intends to adopt artificial intelligence in military operations and to learn it from the Chinese army, within a relationship he described as extending past exchanges into specialised training, equipment supply and institutional development. No Malawian doctrine, oversight body, budget line or civilian-control provision for military artificial intelligence is on file, and the draft national strategy as reported does not cover it.

Mali

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique [recommended a national AI strategy](#), which Mali does not have, alongside an AES protocol on AI governance. The [Centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique closed the week with a demonstration of a locally built intrusion-detection technology](#).

Mali joined a regional framework rather than making one. Six francophone West African states [adopted common artificial-intelligence governance guidelines on 9 July](#), led by an advocacy organisation and announced at the [Global Dialogue on AI Governance](#). The guidelines are non-binding and no Malian implementing instrument follows from them on the record.

Mauritius

The [AI Registry went live on 9 July 2026](#), a week before the summit that showcased it: a directory of Mauritius-relevant models, agents and skills carrying provider identity and any institutional validation, which does not host or sell what it lists. The stack is open-sourced and is being offered to other operators.

The [same keynote recorded a retreat](#): the schools pilot moved from a student tutor to a teacher assistant after teacher and parent resistance.

The month closed with the state's AI apparatus being measured from outside it. On [27 July the chamber of commerce and two partners launched an adoption, readiness and governance study](#), because there is no clear picture of adoption among Mauritian firms or of what skills exist. The AI City Scheme has no drafted narrative this period.

Mozambique

Mozambique signed the agreement establishing the World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization in Shanghai on 16 July 2026, as one of 29 founding member states and one of ten African ones ([signing account](#)). No ratification step, entry-into-force date or contribution is stated in the held account.

The Intellectual Property Policy and Strategy 2026-2035, approved by resolution on 30 June and reported on 22 July, mandates a study on the impact of the digital environment and artificial intelligence on the intellectual property framework, including the patentability of inventions made by artificial intelligence, and costs legal and institutional modernisation at 719.6m meticaïs ([approval account](#)). The resolution and strategy text are not held, and every provision and figure is the reporting agency's reading of the document.

On 28 July the communications minister told the same banking and finance conference that current national infrastructure, data centres included, cannot support more advanced artificial-intelligence models ([ministerial account](#)).

Namibia

The month's artificial-intelligence work is language work. The development programme's account of 13 August records [an indigenous-language voice-data repository being built through its AI sprint with the national science and technology university](#). No language count, corpus size, licence or release date is stated, and the question a speech corpus raises above all others — who owns the recorded voices, and on what terms they may train a model — is not addressed in the account.

Nigeria

Nothing moved on the national AI policy, the risk-based regime inside the digital-economy bill, or the surveillance estate.

The activity was at the state level and abroad. Anambra State [set out a Vision 2030 push on artificial intelligence and paperless government that its own ICT agency says is constrained by weak connectivity and computing capacity](#), with no budget, procurement, delivery date or named system published. The federal IT agency [signed two memoranda in Toronto with Canadian firms on financial inclusion, local AI infrastructure, technology transfer and digital skills](#), and separately [pushed a National Sovereign Cloud initiative against a stated position in which over 85% of workloads run on public cloud largely hosted abroad](#). None of the three carries a value, a timetable or a delivery commitment.

Rwanda

Rwanda and a North African state signed an artificial-intelligence and digital-transformation memorandum on 10 July, with no funding, deliverable or timeline stated. The head of state was confirmed on 3 July as co-chair of an international commission on artificial intelligence, with no national work programme attached to the seat.

At the internet governance forum on 30 July a ministry official said artificial intelligence is already in use in Rwandan health, education and fraud detection. The national agency approved in June still has no published structure, budget, law or implementation timeline.

On 13 August the ICT ministry [held a two-day working session with a hyperscaler to scope a structured artificial-intelligence partnership](#) spanning digital public infrastructure, data exchange, cloud, cybersecurity and skills. Nothing was signed and no value or timetable was given. The question a scoping session of that breadth raises — on what terms national data would sit with a foreign provider — is not addressed in the account.

Senegal

A national prize ceremony on 30 July presented a [Wolof and French AI tutor reachable by ordinary phone call with no internet, its curriculum validated by school inspectors and hosted on servers in Senegal](#). No user, pricing or evaluation figure is given, and the education ministry's role is asserted by the vendor rather than confirmed by it. The same readiness assessment records an [ethics committee as planned](#), with no statute, membership or chair. The state's own AI build was presented abroad rather than at home: the Senegal AI Factory was [set out to an international AI-process meeting in Tokyo as the main component of the Senegal Digital Factory under the technology strategy's eighth priority programme, covering national AI capability, startups, applied research and training](#), with no launch date, budget, compute location or partner commitment stated.

Seychelles

[Cabinet approved a National AI in Education Framework 2026-2030 on 22 July 2026](#), reported by State House on 31 July: a 21-page policy covering every state school, integrating AI literacy across the curriculum, requiring a mandatory AI micro-credential for teachers, naming an AI Champion per school and establishing a Steering Committee to maintain approved and prohibited AI-tool lists. Two World Bank pilots — an AI Teacher Coach for

Primary 5–6 teachers and an AI Student Tutor for Secondary 3 Maths and Geography — were already running ahead of the Framework's approval. Neither the Framework's own text nor a budget or implementation timeline has been published; a first automated acquisition attempt on 9 August failed to locate the document.

Sierra Leone

DSTI reported on 24 July that its [deepfake and digital-misinformation campaign, running since May 2026, has reached Freetown, Makeni, Port Loko, Magburaka, Bo, Kenema and Kono](#), convening paramount chiefs, district officials, security institutions, councils and universities, with participants reporting voice-cloning scams impersonating public figures. Broadcast programming, a national capacity-building workshop and a verification chatbot are announced as the next phase. No budget, funder or completion date is stated, and no legislative or platform-facing instrument accompanies it.

Somalia

The Somali National University [launched an AI centre on 20 July](#) for research and digital skills. No funding, staffing or research programme is stated, and the country still holds no national artificial intelligence policy of any kind.

South Africa

The Labour Court [stayed disciplinary proceedings](#) against three municipal employees on prima facie evidence that a ruling relied on authorities that do not exist. SARS disclosed that [100% of verification cases and 88.41% of complex audits](#) are selected by automated risk assessment. Huawei reported [1,400 local partners accounting for 94.7% of its local revenue](#) at its Sandton partner event, where South Africa's founding membership of the China-led World AI Cooperation Organisation was noted; the figures are company-reported.

The measured incidence of AI-enabled harm remains low and the reason is contested. An analysis of an incident database published on 14 August [links South Africa to 12 of more than 1,600 recorded global cases through April 2026](#), attributing the low count to public wariness rather than to strong defences, against deepfake, fabricated-citation and biometric-verification incidents already on record. It is a count of *recorded* cases, and no national reporting duty exists that would make the denominator meaningful.

Tanzania

At an international AI meeting on 18 July the ICT minister stated that a [national AI data centre is under construction, justified on ending raw-data export and training models on domestic hydro and geothermal power](#), and that a Kiswahili large language model is set out in the national vision. No site, cost, capacity, operator or completion date was given for the centre, and no developer, budget, corpus or timetable for the model.

Twelve days later, at a training event on 30 July, an archives officer said [government is still drafting AI guidelines](#); an [external policy outlook published the same day placed Tanzania among states still developing a strategy](#).

Three deployments were reported. A cardiac institute stated on 16 July that its [digital patient tracking system is in use for medical-camp follow-up](#), alongside AI-enabled echocardiography and contactless vital-signs monitoring, with no patient volumes or procurement route. A peer-reviewed study published 3 August reported a ports enquiry chatbot at [95.1% weighted task success with fifteen domain experts](#), with no production deployment. At the agricultural exhibition on 4 August a university showed [a medicine-authenticity lookup at development stage and a voice-driven mobile-money service for blind users in testing](#); both are student prototypes, self-reported, with no institutional partner, regulator or funder named.

Togo

Three artificial-intelligence positions all rest on announcements rather than output. A [national-languages speech and translation project](#) targets at least fifty hours of validated recordings and 6,000 translated sentence pairs for each of fifty languages, with four data competitions carrying US\$40,000 in prizes — targets only, with no collected-hours figure, released model or completion date on file. The same laboratory runs satellite, mobility and text data for agriculture, health, education and the environment, on the single source the base holds for it. Togo is also a founding government of a [pan-African African-language coalition](#) launched with four private partners, and nothing held states how it relates to Togo's own fifty-language project.

Tunisia

The period's artificial-intelligence document came from outside the state. A diaspora alumni association [presented a Livre Blanc at the Tunisia Global Forum on 21-22 July](#) and its contents were [reported on 5 August 2026](#): a 2030 vision of a country able to create, adopt and deploy trustworthy artificial intelligence, against a stated baseline of 12.7% adoption at end-2025 and 4,120 developers per million inhabitants. It [names the constraints as the absence of large-scale data centres and sovereign compute, brain drain, and small firms that are 90% of the economic fabric](#), and prescribes frugal compute investment sized by measured demand. The document is declared open source and is not posted anywhere reachable, so all of that is held at press-summary precision.

The state's own document surfaced at the end of the window and settles a gap this ledger has carried. At a restricted ministerial council on 16 August the communication technologies minister [set out the main lines of a National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2026-2030](#). That establishes the instrument exists and is dated; it does not publish it. No adopted text, cabinet decision, budget or roadmap accompanies the presentation, so the strategy moves from *not held to* in development and no further.

Uganda

On 30 July an external policy outlook [recorded Uganda as still developing an artificial-intelligence strategy](#) alongside a readiness assessment, sixteen months after the strategy was described as being in its final stages. On 2 August the minister of ICT told the Editors Guild annual general meeting in Jinja that the ministry is [developing a policy to regulate artificial intelligence and social media](#); no scope, drafting stage, responsible body, consultation route or timetable was given. Editors at the same meeting raised data-protection exposure from digitised newsroom operations.

Zambia

The same 17 July statement disclosed an opportunity to establish Zambia's first artificial intelligence laboratory with the International Telecommunication Union, with no signature, funding, siting or timetable reported ([statement](#)). On 30 July the home affairs permanent secretary cited the cyber security agency's establishment as strengthening the response to online scams and artificial-intelligence-enabled trafficking, placing organised crime inside a cyber regulator's remit.

On 28 July an implementing partner published a first-hand account of automating public query handling at the National Assembly, consolidating budget and administrative data and surfacing information to members during debates and committee hearings. The same account reports parliamentary staff using public artificial intelligence tools on personal judgment, limited monitoring of what data flows into those platforms, and no consistent approach to hallucinations — findings the partner reports from two other African parliaments as well.

Zimbabwe

The same 29 July address committed to indigenous-language corpora work led by universities ([launch account](#)).

The listed infrastructure company described its remote monitoring system and digital twin as advancing rather than in production for the quarter ended May 2026 ([trading update](#)).

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